

Xiaolong Cheng

Postdoctoral Applicant | LiDAR SLAM, Real-World 3D Reconstruction, and Multi-Robot Exploration

Email: xiaolong_cheng@seu.edu | Phone: +86 15952085806 | Web: <https://huashu996.github.io>

RESEARCH PROFILE

Ph.D. candidate in Mechanical Engineering at Southeast University, specializing in multi-sensor fusion SLAM, UAV navigation and 3D reconstruction, and air-ground collaborative robotic systems. My research focuses on robust localization and mapping in challenging environments, with expertise in sensor fusion, cross-platform adaptation, and real-time robotic perception. I am seeking a postdoctoral position in SLAM, autonomous systems, and collaborative robotics.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Multi-Sensor fusion SLAM and robust localization in challenging environments
- UAV Navigation and 3D Reconstruction
- Multi-robot exploration, coordination, and cooperative mapping
- Air-ground collaborative SLAM and heterogeneous robotic systems

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Mechanical Engineering, Southeast University

09/2021 – 01/2027

Integrated Master-PhD Program, Nanjing, China

National Scholarship (top 3%)

B.Eng. in Mechanical Engineering, Harbin University of Science and Technology

09/2017 – 06/2021

Harbin, China

Corporate Scholarship (top 1%) | Outstanding Graduate Student

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

● Journal Articles

[1] **X. Cheng** et al., "Onion-LO: Why Does LiDAR Odometry Fail Across Different LiDAR Types and Scenarios?," IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (**RAL**), 2025. Code: <https://github.com/huashu996/Onion-LO>. (**KITTI Odometry Rank: 26th**)

[2] **X. Cheng** et al., "LIVOX-CAM: Adaptive Coarse-to-Fine Visual-Assisted LiDAR Odometry for Solid-State LiDAR," IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (**RAL**), 2025. Code: <https://github.com/huashu996/LIVOX-CAM>.

[3] **X. Cheng** et al., "SLBAF-Net: Super-Lightweight Bimodal Adaptive Fusion Network for UAV Detection in Low-Recognition Environment," Multimedia Tools and Applications, 2023. Code: <https://github.com/huashu996/SLBAF-Net>.

[4] K. Geng, **X. Cheng**, P. Ding, K. Shen, T. Ma, and G. Yin, "A Review of Key Technologies in Air-Ground Collaborative Systems" [in Chinese], Journal of Mechanical Engineering (**CJME**), doi: 10.3901/JME.260208.

● Conference Papers

[5] **X. Cheng**, Y. Sun, K. Geng, T. Ma, and Z. Liu, "Onion-LO++: An Adaptive and Degradation-Resistant Continuous-Time LiDAR Odometry," in Proceedings of the IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (**ICRA**), 2026. Code: <https://github.com/huashu996/Onion-LO++>.

[6] **X. Cheng** et al., "SVM-LO: An Accurate, Robust, Real-Time LiDAR Odometry With Segmentation Voxel Map for Autonomous Vehicles," in 2024 IEEE 27th International Conference on Intelligent Transportation Systems (**ITSC**), 2024.

[7] **X. Cheng** et al., "Semantic Mapping Optimization Based on LiDAR and Camera Data Fusion for Autonomous Vehicle," in 2022 6th CAA International Conference on Vehicular Control and Intelligence (**CVCI**), 2022. Code: https://github.com/huashu996/camera_lidar_semantic_slam.

● Under Revision

[8] **X. Cheng**, K. Geng, C. Ma, Z. Lin, Y. Sun, and T. Ma*, "NDT-CAM: A Simple, Adaptive, and Robust Visual-Assisted LiDAR Odometry for High-Altitude Mapping," Robotics and Autonomous Systems (**RAS**), major revision. Code: <https://github.com/huashu996/NDT-CAM>.

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ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer for IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)

Reviewer for ICRA, IROS, and ITSC

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Air–Ground Collaborative SLAM | Project Leader

11/2025 – present

Developed a UAV–UGV collaborative robotic system for cooperative localization and true-color 3D reconstruction, integrating multi-sensor platform calibration, wireless inter-robot communication, and real-time collaborative SLAM for mapping, localization, and autonomous obstacle avoidance.

LiDAR–Vision Fusion-Based Intelligent Road Inspection System | Project Leader

03/2025 – 11/2025

Developed a public bus multi-sensor mapping system for urban elevated roads, integrating GPS, LiDAR, and vision sensors to support road surface reconstruction, road distress localization, dynamic object removal, and quantitative distress area estimation through LiDAR–camera SLAM and visual detection fusion, resulting in **publication [3]**.

AVP-SLAM Localization System Development | Project Leader

10/2024 – 02/2025

Led the development of a LiDAR-based autonomous valet parking system using a pre-built global map of a multi-level underground parking garage. The project involved constructing a high-resolution 3D point cloud map, developing a pure LiDAR relocalization algorithm for AVP scenarios, and designing an adaptive LiDAR odometry method to improve robustness across different parking environments, resulting in **publication [2]**.

Large-Scale Scenic Area Mapping for Autonomous Vehicles | Project Leader

03/2024 – 06/2024

Constructed a clean 4.5 km point cloud map of a large scenic area using tightly coupled LiDAR–inertial SLAM, dynamic object removal, and loop-closure-based back-end optimization. The resulting map provides an accurate and reliable prior map for autonomous sightseeing vehicles operating in complex outdoor environments.

Mining Area Volume Estimation Based on UAV LiDAR SLAM | Project Leader

02/2024 – 06/2024

Led the development of a UAV-based LiDAR–camera data acquisition and mapping system for mining-area reconstruction and stockpile volume estimation. The project involved integrating LiDAR and visible-light cameras on a UAV platform, designing a LiDAR–camera–IMU fusion mapping algorithm for accurate 3D reconstruction, and performing point cloud densification, region-of-interest cropping, and volumetric analysis, resulting in **publication [8]**.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Programming: C++, Python, ROS/ROS2, PyTorch, Linux

Libraries/Tools: PCL, OpenCV, Eigen, Ceres Solver, GTSAM, Gazebo, RViz, Docker, Git

Platforms: DJI UAV platforms, UGV, LiDAR, RGB/infrared cameras, GPS/RTK, IMU, NVIDIA Jetson systems

SELECTED HONORS

National Gold Award, Intelligent Driving Challenge, 2022

National Second Prize, 19th Huawei Cup Postgraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling, 2022

International Meritorious Winner, Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM), 2020

National Second Prize, National Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling, 2019

REFERENCES

Keke Geng, Associate Professor, Southeast University | jsgengke@seu.edu.cn

Guodong Yin, Professor, Southeast University | ygd@seu.edu.cn

Xiaoyuan Zhu, Associate Professor, Southeast University | zhuxy@seu.edu.cn